

## ATPL EASA STUDY GUIDE | 090 - COMMUNICATIONS

## Chapter 3: Aerodrome Control Communications

Syllabus Source: CAE Oxford (pp. 61-88) | Pass Target: &gt;= 90% AviationExam

### 1. DEPARTURE INFORMATION & PUSHBACK / START-UP

Prior to requesting start-up or taxi, the flight crew must monitor ATIS and obtain local aerodrome information:

- ATIS Acknowledgment: 'INFORMATION CHARLIE RECEIVED, QNH 1014'.
- Start-up Request: Pilot: 'REQUEST START UP'. Controller: 'START UP APPROVED' or 'EXPECT START UP AT 35'.
- Pushback Request: Pilot: 'REQUEST PUSHBACK'. Controller: 'PUSHBACK APPROVED, FACING EAST'.
- Taxi Request: Pilot: 'REQUEST TAXI'. Controller: 'TAXI TO HOLDING POINT RUNWAY 27 VIA TAXIWAY ALPHA'. Readback: 'TAXI TO HOLDING POINT RUNWAY 27 VIA TAXIWAY ALPHA, IBERIA 123'.

### 2. HOLDING POINT PROCEDURES & RUNWAY CROSSINGS

**[!] EXAM TRAP (AVIATIONEXAM) - Runway Safety & Mandatory Holding Point Readback**

- A clearance to 'TAXI TO HOLDING POINT RUNWAY 27' is NOT a clearance to enter the runway! - The aircraft MUST HOLD SHORT of the yellow illuminated runway holding position markings.
- Runway Crossing: Requires explicit, distinct clearance: 'CROSS RUNWAY 09, REPORT VACATED'. The readback MUST include the runway designator: 'CROSS RUNWAY 09, WILCO, IBERIA 123'.

### 3. CONDITIONAL CLEARANCES (STRICT ICAO FORMAT)

Conditional clearances involve an aircraft being cleared to line up, cross, or take off subject to a preceding movement. To eliminate runway incursions, ICAO mandates a strict 3-part phrasing sequence:

| Conditional Element        | Operational Purpose              | Exact ICAO Phraseology Example                                               |
|----------------------------|----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. The Condition           | Preceding traffic identification | 'IBERIA 456, BEHIND LANDING AIRBUS A320...'                                  |
| 2. The Clearance           | Action authorized                | '...LINE UP AND WAIT RUNWAY 27...'                                           |
| 3. Repetition of Condition | Re-affirmation of restriction    | '...BEHIND.'                                                                 |
| Mandatory Readback         | Full verbatim repetition         | 'BEHIND LANDING AIRBUS A320, LINE UP AND WAIT RUNWAY 27 BEHIND, IBERIA 456.' |

### 4. TAKE-OFF, ABORTED TAKE-OFF & LANDING CLEARANCES

- Line Up & Wait: 'LINE UP AND WAIT RUNWAY 27' (or 'LINE UP RUNWAY 27 AND WAIT').
- Take-off Clearance: 'CLEARED FOR TAKE-OFF RUNWAY 27, WIND 250 DEGREES 10 KNOTS'. Readback: 'CLEARED FOR TAKE-OFF RUNWAY 27, IBERIA 123'.
- Cancelling Take-off Clearance (Before Roll): Controller: 'TAKE-OFF CLEARANCE CANCELLED, HOLD POSITION'. Pilot: 'HOLDING, IBERIA 123'.

- Aborting Take-off (Emergency During Roll): Controller: 'STOP IMMEDIATELY, IBERIA 123 STOP IMMEDIATELY'. Pilot: 'STOPPING, IBERIA 123'.
- Landing Clearance: 'CLEARED TO LAND RUNWAY 27, WIND 260 DEGREES 12 KNOTS'.
- Missed Approach / Go-Around: Controller: 'GO AROUND, CLIMB TO 3000 FEET'. Pilot: 'GOING AROUND, IBERIA 123'.
- Runway Vacated: Pilot: 'RUNWAY VACATED' (transmitted only after the entire aircraft is clear of the runway holding markings).

## 5. VFR TRAFFIC CIRCUIT POSITION REPORTS

| Circuit Position | Flight Path Geometry          | Standard ICAO Radio Phraseology                                                                            |
|------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Downwind         | Opposite direction to landing | Transmit aircraft type, intentions (touch-and-go / full stop): 'G-ABCD, DOWNWIND RUNWAY 27, TOUCH AND GO'. |
| Base Leg         | Turn onto base                | Transmit: 'G-ABCD, BASE RUNWAY 27'.                                                                        |
| Final            | Aligned with runway (< 4 NM)  | Transmit: 'G-ABCD, FINAL RUNWAY 27'.                                                                       |
| Long Final       | Aligned at greater distance   | Transmit: 'G-ABCD, LONG FINAL RUNWAY 27' (between 4 and 8 NM from touchdown).                              |

## 6. AVIATIONEXAM PRACTICE QUESTIONS (WITH EXPLANATIONS)

### Q1: What is the correct phraseology used by a controller to instruct an aircraft to abort its take-off roll immediately?

[A] 'Abort take-off, cancel clearance' [B] 'Stop immediately, Speedbird 123 stop immediately' [C] 'Speedbird 123, hold position' [D] 'Discontinue take-off now'

#### [\*] OFFICIAL DEFINITION - Detailed Answer Explanation

CORRECT: [B]. The standard emergency phraseology to abort an active take-off roll is 'STOP IMMEDIATELY' repeated twice, addressed with aircraft callsign.

### Q2: In a conditional clearance, what must be transmitted first by the controller?

[A] The clearance to line up [B] The condition (identification of preceding traffic) [C] The surface wind [D] The aircraft callsign followed by 'cleared'

#### [\*] OFFICIAL DEFINITION - Detailed Answer Explanation

CORRECT: [B]. Under ICAO standards, the condition must always precede the clearance (e.g. 'Behind landing B737, line up and wait behind').

### Q3: When should a pilot transmit the phrase 'RUNWAY VACATED'?

[A] As soon as the main wheels touch down [B] When the nose gear crosses the runway edge line [C] Only when the entire aircraft has passed beyond the runway holding position marking [D] When parked on the apron

#### [\*] OFFICIAL DEFINITION - Detailed Answer Explanation

CORRECT: [C]. 'Runway vacated' is transmitted only when all parts of the aircraft are completely past the runway holding line.

### Q4: An aircraft is instructed: 'Taxi to holding point runway 09 via taxiway Bravo'. Does this authorize the aircraft to taxi onto runway 09?

[A] Yes, if no traffic is visible [B] No, the pilot must hold short of runway 09 until receiving an explicit clearance to cross [C] Yes, after transmitting 'Crossing' [D] Only in daytime VMC

**[\*] OFFICIAL DEFINITION - Detailed Answer Explanation**

CORRECT: [B]. Taxi clearances to a holding point strictly terminate at the holding point. Crossing any runway requires an explicit separate clearance.

**Q5: What is the correct phraseology for an aircraft commencing a missed approach on final approach?**

[A] 'Aborting landing' [B] 'Going around' [C] 'Pulling up' [D] 'Cancelling landing'

**[\*] OFFICIAL DEFINITION - Detailed Answer Explanation**

CORRECT: [B]. 'GOING AROUND' is the standard ICAO radiotelephony phraseology for initiating a missed approach.

**Q6: At what distance from the runway threshold is an aircraft considered to be on 'Long Final'?**

[A] Between 1 and 2 NM [B] Between 4 and 8 NM [C] Beyond 15 NM [D] Under 1 NM

**[\*] OFFICIAL DEFINITION - Detailed Answer Explanation**

CORRECT: [B]. 'Long Final' is reported when an aircraft is turning onto final approach or tracking final at a distance greater than 4 NM (typically 4 to 8 NM).